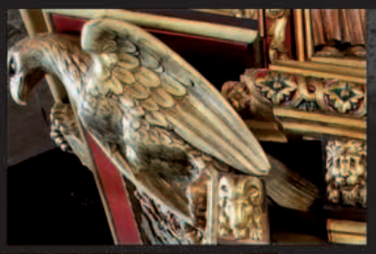


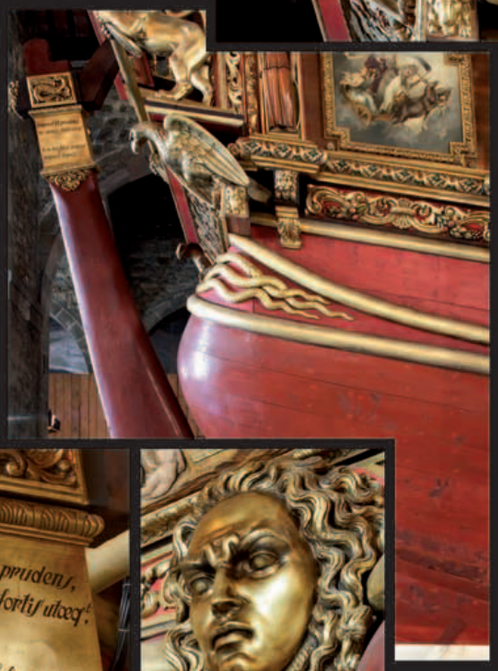


« Stern lantern
The poop deck, where the helmsman controlled the tiller, is crowned with three ornate lanterns, beacons for keeping the fleet together at night.

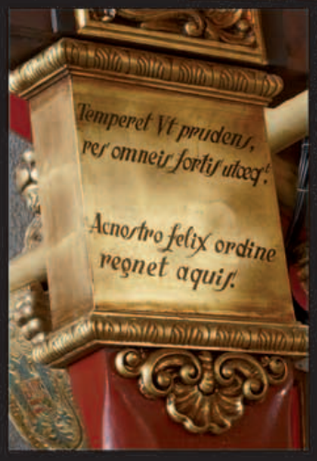
» Imperial ambition
The gilded eagles on the stern are a reference to the Roman Empire and Christian Europe's desire to win back Rome's former possessions from Ottoman domination.



» Rudder
The rudders fitted on Mediterranean galleys were smaller than those found on sailing ships of comparable size. It was always possible to use the oars to alter course.



» Latin motto
The motto engraved at the top of the rudder extols the virtues of prudence and strength, essential qualities needed to control the power of the sea.



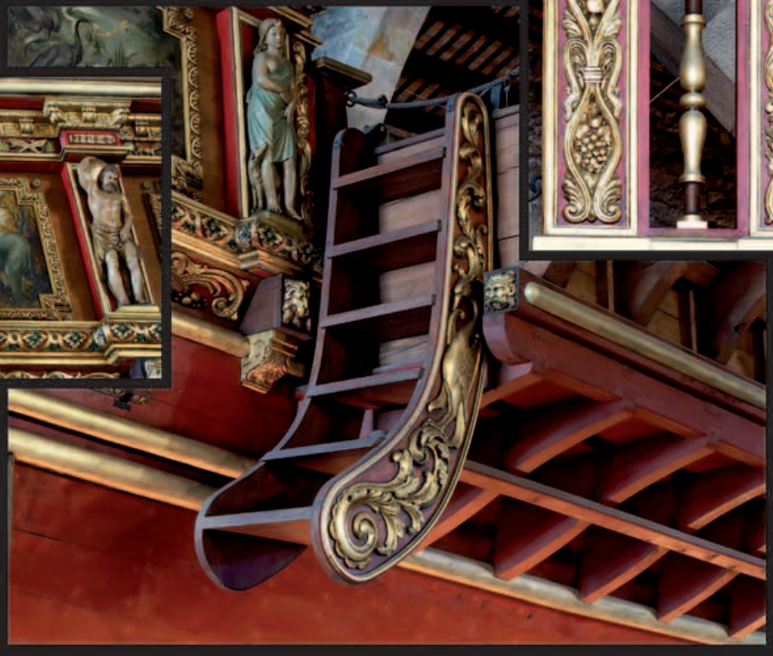


« Head of Medusa
The gorgon Medusa stares out from the the stern, deflecting evil and bringing destruction to Don John's enemies.

« Statues on the stern
The frieze at the top shows Hercules in the Garden of the Hesperides. Below, the two lions hold the coats of arms of Austria and the Order of the Golden Fleece, while the four female figures represent Christian virtues.



« Paintings with a moral
The painting of Time's chariot suggests that the leader must seize any opportunity when it comes, while the elephant and the rhinoceros about to do battle express the idea "be ready for victory or death."



» Entry ports
The pair of curved ladders on either side of the poop were used for embarking and disembarking. LIke everything else at the stern end of the galley, they are richly decorated with gilded reliefs.



« Gilded baluster
Every tiny detail around the stern of the ship, where the admiral and his officers were housed in the poop, is richly carved and decorated.

» Fancy scuppers
Even the scuppers, the ports that could be opened to let excess water run off the decks, contributed to the decorative scheme of Don John's galley.

